

A Project Report
Course Name: Service Learning (BCA613)
Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the Service Learning Project of
the degree of
Bachelor of Computer Applications

Cyber Fraud and Cyber Crime Awareness

in

Department of Computer Applications



Submitted by

Harshvardhan

UNIVERSITY ROLL NO.: 123308130029

Class: BCA 6th A

Under the guidance of

Jaspreet Kaur

Assistant Professor

FACULTY OF COMPUTING
GURU KASHI UNIVERSITY
TALWANDI SABO (PUNJAB), INDIA

Session: 2023-26

Submission Date: 19 May 2026

1. CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that Harshvardhan, a student of BCA Final Year, has successfully completed the Service Learning Project titled “Cyber Fraud and Cyber Crime Awareness” under the guidance of the faculty of the Department of Computer Applications, Guru Kashi University.

The project was undertaken as a service-learning activity to create awareness in the community regarding rising cyber frauds such as OTP fraud, social media scams, phishing, online banking fraud, identity theft, and cyberbullying. The work combines academic understanding with public awareness and practical safety measures.

To the best of my knowledge, this report is the original work of the student and fulfils the requirements prescribed for the course. The project reflects sincere effort, community interaction, and a strong understanding of the importance of cyber safety in everyday digital life.

Professor Sign.

Head of Department

2. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I express my sincere gratitude to my teachers, guide, and the Department of Computer Applications for giving me the opportunity to complete this Service Learning Project on cyber fraud awareness. Their guidance helped me understand how digital crimes affect ordinary users and why public awareness is essential.

Through this project, I learned that cyber criminals do not always depend on advanced hacking tools; very often, they misuse trust, fear, urgency, and lack of awareness. By studying real situations and speaking with community members, I was able to understand the practical side of cyber safety.

I also thank the people who participated in the awareness activity, discussed their online experiences, and supported the completion of this report. Their cooperation made the project more meaningful and helped connect classroom learning with social responsibility.

Harshvardhan

3. TABLE OF CONTENTS

Section	Page
Certificate	2
Acknowledgement	3
Table of Contents	4
Introduction	5
Objectives of the Project	6
Why Cyber Fraud Awareness Matters	7
Research Methodology and Community Interaction	8
OTP Fraud	9-13
Social Media Scams	14-18
Phishing	19-22
Online Banking Fraud	23-26
Identity Theft	27-30
Cyber bullying	31-34
Comparative Analysis of Major Cyber Frauds	35
General Safety Guidelines for Students and Families	36
Government Reporting Mechanisms and Digital Hygiene	37
Attendance Sheet	38
Photographs and Awareness Activity Notes	39
Conclusion	40

4. INTRODUCTION

In the present digital age, the use of smartphones, online platforms, UPI services, social media applications, and internet banking has become a normal part of daily life. People use digital tools for communication, education, shopping, entertainment, and financial transactions because they are fast, convenient, and widely available.

However, the same digital convenience has also increased the risk of cyber crime. Cyber fraud refers to illegal activities carried out through computers, mobile devices, digital platforms, or communication networks in order to steal money, data, identity, or emotional security from users.

Modern cyber criminals often do not break into systems by force. Instead, they misuse human behavior. They create fear, urgency, curiosity, greed, or trust and convince people to reveal information, click harmful links, transfer money, or believe fake identities. This is why cyber awareness is as important as technical security.

This project studies major forms of cyber fraud with special attention to OTP fraud, social media scams, phishing, online banking fraud, identity theft, and cyberbullying. The purpose is to keep the existing project content intact while expanding it into a more complete awareness report that can help students, families, and community members stay safe online.

5. OBJECTIVES OF THE PROJECT

The main purpose of this service learning activity is to spread practical awareness about common cyber frauds and encourage responsible digital behavior among internet users.

- To explain how common cyber frauds work in simple language.
- To spread awareness about OTP fraud and social media scams already covered in the original report.
- To expand the report by adding phishing, online banking fraud, identity theft, and cyberbullying.
- To help people identify warning signs before financial or emotional harm takes place.
- To promote safe use of mobile banking, social media, and digital communication tools.
- To encourage quick reporting of suspicious activity through official channels.
- To build confidence among users so they can use digital services more safely and responsibly.

6. WHY CYBER FRAUD AWARENESS MATTERS

Cyber fraud is not only a technical issue; it is a social issue. School students, college students, elderly people, shopkeepers, salaried employees, and homemakers can all become victims because fraudsters target human habits rather than only technical weaknesses.

A single careless action, such as sharing an OTP, clicking a fake banking link, or trusting a duplicate social media account, can lead to financial loss, emotional stress, identity misuse, and loss of confidence in digital systems. Victims may also face long complaint processes, account recovery delays, and social embarrassment.

Awareness reduces risk. When users know the common patterns of fraud, they become more careful with calls, messages, links, passwords, and payment requests. Awareness also improves community safety because informed users warn others, verify information, and report fraud quickly.

For students in particular, cyber awareness is important because they spend a large amount of time online for learning, social networking, gaming, and payments. Safe habits developed early can prevent serious harm later in life.

7. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY AND COMMUNITY INTERACTION

This report is based on a service-learning approach that combines classroom understanding with community awareness. The topic was selected because cyber frauds are increasing rapidly and many people still do not understand how simple tricks are used to steal money or personal information.

The study involved reading awareness material, observing real examples reported in news and public discussions, and interacting with community members to understand their knowledge level about cyber safety. Questions focused on OTP sharing, fake calls, suspicious links, online payments, social media requests, and reporting methods.

The awareness activity highlighted an important pattern: many users know that fraud exists, but they do not always recognize the exact moment when a scam begins. This gap between general awareness and practical response makes educational outreach very important.

The final report therefore explains each topic in simple and structured language so that the material can be used for self-study, classroom discussion, and public awareness sessions.

8. OTP FRAUD

OTP (One-Time Password) fraud is a type of cyber crime in which fraudsters trick individuals into revealing their OTP and then use it to perform unauthorized transactions. An OTP is a temporary security code sent to a user's mobile number or email during login, payment, or banking verification.

The purpose of an OTP is to add a second layer of protection. But if the user shares it with another person, this protection becomes useless. Fraudsters misuse this moment to access bank accounts, wallets, UPI apps, or cards and complete transactions without the victim's informed consent.

OTP fraud is one of the most common cyber crimes because it does not always require deep technical hacking. It mainly depends on manipulation. The scam succeeds when the victim believes the caller or message and acts in panic or trust.

Because OTP fraud directly targets financial accounts, it can cause instant monetary loss. For this reason, every digital user must clearly understand that an OTP is secret and should never be shared under any circumstance.

9. PSYCHOLOGY BEHIND OTP FRAUD

The success of OTP fraud depends mainly on psychological manipulation rather than technical methods. Fraudsters create fear by saying that the bank account will be blocked, the KYC will expire, or a transaction is under verification. Fear makes victims react quickly instead of thinking carefully.

Urgency is another major tool. Phrases such as “share the OTP now” or “your account will be suspended immediately” prevent the victim from verifying the message independently. In many cases, the victim acts within seconds.

Fraudsters also misuse authority. They pretend to be bank officials, customer care executives, SIM providers, or government representatives. Many people automatically trust formal language and professional tone, especially when the caller knows their name or partial account details.

The lesson is clear: OTP fraud works because it targets human emotions such as fear, trust, confusion, and hurry. A calm response is the strongest defense.

10. WORKING PROCESS OF OTP FRAUD

The process of OTP fraud usually starts when fraudsters collect the victim's phone number from leaked databases, social media, online forms, or random calling patterns. They then contact the victim pretending to be from a trusted institution.

Next, they create a fake problem such as incomplete KYC, blocked card, reward redemption, or account verification. At the same time, they trigger a real login or transaction so that an OTP is generated and sent to the victim's mobile number.

The victim receives the OTP and the fraudster asks for it in the name of verification. As soon as the OTP is shared, the criminal completes the unauthorized transaction. In some cases, the victim is also asked to install a remote access app or approve a payment request.

This chain proves that the scam is successful only when the victim unknowingly participates. Awareness at that single step can stop the fraud completely.

11. TYPES OF OTP FRAUD

Common forms of OTP fraud include fake bank verification calls, KYC update scams, UPI collect request scams, card-block warnings, SIM swap fraud, and remote access fraud. In each case, the fraudster changes the story but the goal remains the same: obtain the OTP or security approval.

In bank call fraud, the criminal speaks like a bank employee and asks for OTP verification. In KYC fraud, the victim is told that documents must be updated immediately. In UPI fraud, the victim is misled into approving a payment request while believing money will be received.

SIM swap fraud is more dangerous because the criminal attempts to obtain control of the victim's mobile number and receive OTPs directly. Remote access fraud adds another layer of risk by making the victim install screen-sharing or phone-control apps.

Understanding these forms helps users recognize that the wording may change, but the rule never changes: no genuine authority asks for your OTP.

12. CASE STUDY, IMPACT AND PREVENTION OF OTP FRAUD

A working professional once received a call from a person claiming to be a bank representative. The caller said that urgent KYC verification was needed and asked the victim to share the OTP received on the phone. Trusting the caller, the victim shared the code and within minutes a large amount of money was deducted from the account.

OTP fraud creates immediate financial loss, emotional stress, regret, and loss of confidence in digital banking. Victims also spend significant time on complaint filing, account security steps, and follow-up with banks or cyber cells.

The strongest prevention measures are simple: never share OTPs, never act in panic, verify calls independently, avoid suspicious links, install apps only from trusted stores, monitor transaction alerts, and report fraud immediately on the cyber helpline 1930 and the official portal cybercrime.gov.in.

An OTP is a key to the account. Handing it to another person is equal to handing over control of the account itself.

13. SOCIAL MEDIA SCAMS

Social media scams are cyber crimes in which fraudsters use platforms such as Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, Telegram, or similar services to deceive users and steal money, account access, or personal information. These scams spread quickly because social media is built on connection, visibility, and trust.

Fraudsters create fake profiles, copy photos from real accounts, send messages from duplicate IDs, and build confidence before making a request. Sometimes they promise prizes, jobs, or investment returns. At other times they claim to be a friend facing an emergency.

Unlike traditional hacking, social media scams usually rely more on emotional pressure than technical intrusion. The criminal wants the victim to trust the message before verifying it.

Because many users keep their personal details openly visible online, scammers often gather enough background information to make fake messages look genuine and believable.

14. PSYCHOLOGY BEHIND SOCIAL MEDIA SCAMS

The success of social media scams depends on emotional manipulation. Fraudsters make use of sympathy, fear, love, greed, excitement, urgency, and social familiarity. A message that appears to come from a close friend or relative naturally lowers the victim's suspicion.

Another common tactic is attraction through rewards. Messages about lottery wins, easy jobs, limited-time offers, or high returns create excitement and distract the victim from checking facts carefully.

Scammers also exploit the habit of instant messaging. Since people are used to replying quickly on social media, they may not pause to confirm whether the account is genuine or whether the request makes sense.

These patterns show that social media scams work when emotion becomes stronger than verification. Users must remember that digital identity can be faked very easily.

15. WORKING PROCESS OF SOCIAL MEDIA SCAMS

The process usually starts with the creation of a fake or duplicate profile. Fraudsters copy a real person's display picture, name, and bio details to make the account look authentic. They then send friend requests or direct messages to the victim.

Once contact is established, the fraudster builds trust through regular conversation, familiar language, or emotional stories. After this, a fake situation is created, such as a medical emergency, urgent money problem, investment chance, shopping offer, or account verification issue.

The victim is then asked to send money, click a link, share a code, disclose details, or move the conversation to another platform. After receiving the benefit, the scammer often blocks the victim, deletes the account, or stops responding.

The scam therefore moves from fake identity to emotional trust and finally to financial or informational exploitation.

16. TYPES OF SOCIAL MEDIA SCAMS

Common social media scams include fake friend requests, romance scams, lottery or prize scams, fake job offers, investment fraud, fake online shopping pages, giveaway scams, and impersonation of celebrities or public figures.

In fake friend scams, a duplicate profile of someone known to the victim asks for urgent money. In romance scams, emotional bonding is built slowly before a financial request is made. In fake job or shopping scams, the victim is asked to pay registration, booking, or delivery charges.

Investment scams promise unrealistic profits and pressure the victim to send money quickly. Prize scams claim that the victim has won something valuable but must pay a fee or share account details to claim it.

Each form uses a different story, but all of them depend on the same weakness: unverified trust in online profiles and messages.

17. CASE STUDY, IMPACT AND PREVENTION OF SOCIAL MEDIA SCAMS

A student once received an Instagram message from an account that looked exactly like a close friend's profile. The sender said there was an urgent financial problem and requested money immediately. Trusting the identity, the student transferred the amount and later discovered that the real friend had sent no such message.

Social media scams create financial loss, embarrassment, broken trust, emotional stress, and exposure of private information. Some victims also face repeated targeting because scammers share contact lists and responses among themselves.

Users can prevent such scams by verifying profiles, avoiding unknown requests, calling before sending money, using strong privacy settings, enabling two-factor authentication, refusing suspicious links, and reporting or blocking fake accounts immediately.

The most important habit is simple: not everything visible on social media is real. Verification must come before trust.

18. PHISHING

Phishing is a cyber fraud technique in which attackers send fake emails, messages, websites, or login pages to trick users into sharing passwords, banking details, card numbers, OTPs, or other confidential information. The word “phishing” reflects how criminals use bait to trap the victim.

Phishing attacks are dangerous because they are designed to look genuine. A fake page may resemble the real website of a bank, university, shopping platform, courier service, or government portal. The victim feels safe because the visual appearance looks familiar.

Phishing can target anyone, including students, office workers, senior citizens, and business owners. It may come through SMS, email, social media, QR codes, or messaging apps.

As digital life grows, phishing has become one of the most widely used entry points for financial theft, malware installation, account takeover, and identity misuse.

19. HOW PHISHING ATTACKS WORK

A phishing attack usually begins with a message that looks urgent or important. It may say that the bank account needs verification, a parcel is delayed, an exam portal must be updated, or a social media login has been blocked. The message contains a link or attachment.

When the victim clicks the link, a fake login page opens. It may use colors, logos, and wording similar to the real institution. The victim enters credentials, believing the page is genuine. Those details are then collected by the attacker.

In some cases, the victim is asked to download a file that installs malicious software. In other cases, the phishing page asks for card details, CVV, account number, or even OTP. Sometimes the attacker immediately uses the data, and sometimes it is stored for later misuse.

Phishing succeeds when the victim reacts to appearance and urgency instead of checking the sender, URL, or source carefully.

20. COMMON TYPES OF PHISHING

Email phishing is the most common type, where fake emails imitate trusted organizations. SMS phishing, also called smishing, uses text messages and short links. Voice phishing, or vishing, combines fake calls with false verification stories.

Spear phishing targets a specific person and often includes personal details to appear convincing. Clone phishing copies a real message format and sends a modified version with a harmful link. QR phishing uses QR codes that redirect users to dangerous pages.

Academic users may face phishing through scholarship links, exam notices, or internship offers. Banking customers may face KYC updates, reward redemption messages, or suspicious login alerts.

Different forms of phishing appear on different platforms, but their common goal is theft of trust-based information.

21. IMPACT AND PREVENTION OF PHISHING

Phishing can lead to account compromise, banking loss, malware infection, identity theft, and leakage of personal documents. Once a password is stolen, the attacker may reuse it on multiple services if the victim uses the same password elsewhere.

The best defense is careful verification. Users should check the sender address, inspect website URLs, avoid clicking unknown links, type important websites manually, and never submit passwords or banking information through unexpected messages.

Two-factor authentication, password managers, browser security warnings, and regular password updates also reduce risk. Suspicious emails and messages should be deleted, blocked, or reported rather than explored.

The key lesson is that a professional-looking message is not proof of authenticity. Trust must be based on verification, not appearance.

22. ONLINE BANKING FRAUD

Online banking fraud refers to unauthorized or deceptive activities used to steal money or access from bank accounts through internet banking, mobile banking apps, cards, or UPI-linked services. As digital payments become common, criminals continuously adapt their methods to exploit banking users.

These frauds may involve fake calls, fake apps, phishing links, card skimming, screen-sharing tools, payment request manipulation, or compromised credentials. Some frauds are immediate, while others begin with silent data collection and end with later misuse.

The danger is high because banking systems are closely connected to identity details, mobile numbers, cards, savings, salary accounts, and transaction alerts. A single successful fraud attempt can create serious financial disruption.

Understanding the pattern of online banking fraud is important for every user who relies on net banking, UPI, debit cards, or mobile wallets.

23. WORKING PROCESS OF ONLINE BANKING FRAUD

Online banking fraud often begins with data capture. The criminal collects mobile numbers, partial account information, card details, or login credentials through phishing, social engineering, fake customer support, or leaked records.

Next, the fraudster tries to gain authorization. This may happen through a fake banking page, a remote access app, a UPI collect request, or a call requesting verification. If the attacker gets the password, MPIN, OTP, or card details, the transaction can be initiated quickly.

In many cases, the fraudster divides the stolen amount into smaller transfers or routes it through mule accounts to make tracing difficult. Some criminals also persuade the victim to install malware that captures screen activity or keyboard entries.

The process shows that online banking fraud is not always one action; it is often a chain of small deceptions ending in financial theft.

24. COMMON FORMS OF ONLINE BANKING FRAUD

Common forms include internet banking login theft, UPI payment request scams, fake customer care numbers, debit or credit card misuse, card skimming, QR code fraud, account takeover through phishing, and malware-based mobile banking compromise.

In QR code fraud, victims are told to scan a code to receive money, but the action actually initiates payment. In fake customer care scams, users searching for help online call a fraudulent number and are then manipulated into sharing sensitive information.

Card skimming usually occurs when card data is copied from a machine or merchant point and later used for unauthorized transactions. Account takeover happens when fraudsters control credentials, device access, and verification methods together.

These frauds prove that users must protect not only passwords but also their device access, app permissions, and payment behavior.

25. PREVENTION AND SAFE BANKING HABITS

Users should access banking services only through official apps and websites, keep mobile numbers updated, avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions, and never share MPIN, card PIN, CVV, OTP, or internet banking passwords.

It is also important to enable transaction alerts, review account statements, set spending limits where possible, and lock cards immediately if anything suspicious appears. Customer care numbers should always be taken from the official bank website or app.

Phones used for banking should remain updated, protected by screen lock, and free from unnecessary screen-sharing or remote-control apps. Payment requests should be read carefully because receiving money never requires entering a PIN or authorizing a debit request.

Safe banking depends on three habits: use official channels, verify every request, and react immediately to suspicious activity.

26. IDENTITY THEFT

Identity theft occurs when a criminal steals or misuses another person's personal information in order to impersonate them, open accounts, commit fraud, gain access to services, or damage their reputation. Common data misused in identity theft includes name, address, phone number, Aadhaar details, PAN, bank information, passwords, and social media credentials.

Unlike instant scams, identity theft can create long-term harm. The victim may not even know that their identity has been misused until unusual transactions, account alerts, loan notices, or suspicious messages begin to appear.

As more personal information is shared online through forms, apps, social platforms, and digital documents, the risk of identity misuse increases. Even a small leak of personal data can become part of a larger fraud chain.

Identity theft is therefore both a financial and personal security issue that requires careful management of digital information.

27. SOURCES AND METHODS OF IDENTITY THEFT

Identity theft can begin through phishing, data breaches, stolen documents, fake KYC requests, malware, insecure public Wi-Fi, lost devices, or oversharing on social media. Fraudsters may also gather details from discarded photocopies, screenshots, or public profile information.

Once enough data is collected, criminals may create fake accounts, apply for loans, misuse SIM cards, reset passwords, or impersonate the victim on social media and messaging platforms. Sometimes they combine partial details from many places to build a complete profile.

Students are especially vulnerable when they share ID cards, documents, contact details, or passwords carelessly for scholarships, jobs, rentals, or online registrations. A single document image sent to the wrong person can be misused repeatedly.

This makes data minimization important: share only what is required and only through trusted channels.

28. EFFECTS OF IDENTITY THEFT AND REPORTING STEPS

The effects of identity theft include unauthorized loans, fake SIM issuance, account recovery problems, blackmail, reputation damage, social media impersonation, fraudulent purchases, and loss of personal privacy. In severe cases, victims spend months proving that they did not authorize the misuse.

Early signs may include unknown OTPs, emails about new accounts, calls from lenders, suspicious login alerts, or complaints from contacts about strange messages. These signs should never be ignored.

If identity theft is suspected, the victim should immediately change passwords, inform banks and relevant platforms, block affected cards or accounts, document the incident, and file a complaint through the cyber crime reporting system. If official identity documents are involved, the relevant service provider should also be informed.

Quick action does not erase the breach, but it reduces the damage and helps create a formal record for recovery.

29. PREVENTION OF IDENTITY THEFT

Identity theft can be reduced by using strong and unique passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, avoiding oversharing personal data, locking devices, updating software regularly, and storing documents carefully.

Sensitive files should not be sent casually through unknown chats or uploaded to suspicious websites. If documents must be shared, users should verify the recipient and avoid sending unnecessary full details when partial masking is possible.

Users should also review privacy settings on social media, monitor financial and email alerts, and remain careful about photocopies or screenshots that contain identity information. Shredding or safely disposing of physical copies is equally important.

The core principle is simple: personal information is valuable. It should be treated like money, because criminals can use it to gain money, access, and control.

30. CYBERBULLYING

Cyberbullying refers to the repeated use of digital platforms to harass, threaten, insult, embarrass, intimidate, or emotionally harm another person. It may happen through social media posts, chats, fake accounts, edited photos, online groups, gaming platforms, or anonymous messages.

Unlike ordinary disagreement, cyberbullying is harmful because it is persistent, public, and difficult to escape. A victim may continue seeing abusive content repeatedly or may fear that many people have already viewed it.

Young people are particularly vulnerable because social identity, peer approval, and online visibility play a large role in student life. However, adults can also experience cyberbullying at work, in relationships, or through coordinated online targeting.

Cyberbullying is included in this report because cyber safety is not only about money; it is also about emotional well-being, dignity, and secure participation in digital spaces.

31. FORMS AND WARNING SIGNS OF CYBERBULLYING

Cyberbullying can take many forms, including abusive messages, public humiliation, rumor spreading, posting private photos without permission, fake accounts, impersonation, exclusion from digital groups, blackmail, threats, and repeated trolling.

Warning signs may include sudden fear of checking the phone, withdrawal from online activity, anxiety after receiving notifications, unexplained sadness, sleep disturbance, falling academic performance, or reluctance to discuss online interactions.

Sometimes the bully is known to the victim; at other times, anonymous or fake accounts are used. Group bullying can also occur, where several users participate in harassment at once, increasing emotional pressure on the victim.

Recognizing these signs early is important because digital harm can quickly affect mental health and daily functioning.

32. IMPACT OF CYBERBULLYING

The effects of cyberbullying can be serious and long-lasting. Victims may experience stress, shame, fear, anger, loneliness, low self-esteem, concentration problems, and reduced confidence in both online and offline life.

In students, cyberbullying may affect attendance, academic focus, friendships, and willingness to participate in social or educational activities. It can also create family distress when the victim feels unable to explain what is happening.

Because hurtful content can be shared widely and preserved in screenshots, the victim may feel that the humiliation is permanent. This makes cyberbullying different from many traditional forms of bullying.

Digital safety therefore includes emotional safety. A secure internet environment must protect people from harassment as well as fraud.

33. PREVENTION, SUPPORT AND REPORTING FOR CYBERBULLYING

Cyberbullying can be reduced by using privacy settings, limiting who can contact or tag the user, avoiding unnecessary public disclosure, and blocking abusive accounts quickly. Students should never respond angrily in a way that escalates the situation.

Evidence should be preserved through screenshots, message records, profile links, and dates. This documentation can support reporting to platforms, school authorities, parents, or law enforcement depending on the seriousness of the matter.

Victims should seek support from trusted adults, teachers, guardians, counselors, or friends rather than suffering silently. Online abuse becomes stronger in isolation and weaker when support systems are active.

The most important message is that cyberbullying should not be normalized as “just online fun.” It is real harm and must be addressed with seriousness and empathy.

34. COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS OF MAJOR CYBER FRAUDS

The topics covered in this report show that cyber frauds differ in method but share common patterns. OTP fraud and online banking fraud primarily target money and account access. Phishing and identity theft target sensitive information first and may later lead to financial loss. Social media scams use fake digital identities and emotional persuasion, while cyberbullying mainly harms emotional well-being and personal dignity.

Another common feature is social engineering. In almost every case, the fraudster or abuser depends on human reaction more than system weakness. Fear, trust, urgency, greed, curiosity, sympathy, and social pressure are repeatedly used as tools.

This comparison makes one fact very clear: digital safety cannot depend on passwords alone. It requires awareness, verification, emotional control, privacy habits, and quick reporting. A careful user is the strongest line of defense against most common cyber threats.

35. GENERAL SAFETY GUIDELINES FOR STUDENTS AND FAMILIES

Students and families should treat digital communication carefully, just as they treat important offline documents or money. Unknown calls, unexpected links, duplicate profiles, prize messages, and urgent payment requests should always be viewed with caution.

Strong passwords must be unique for important accounts, and two-factor authentication should be enabled wherever possible. Devices should remain updated, locked, and free from untrusted apps. Public posting of private details such as address, school information, document images, and daily routine should be limited.

Family discussion also matters. Parents and guardians should talk openly with children and young adults about scams, pressure tactics, fake accounts, and harmful online behavior. Safe habits become stronger when awareness is shared inside the home as well as in educational institutions.

Digital convenience should be used with digital discipline. Small daily precautions prevent major future losses.

36. GOVERNMENT REPORTING MECHANISMS AND DIGITAL HYGIENE

When cyber fraud takes place, quick reporting is essential. Victims should immediately contact the national cyber crime helpline 1930 and submit a complaint through the official portal cybercrime.gov.in. Banks, card issuers, and relevant platforms should also be informed without delay.

Digital hygiene refers to healthy day-to-day practices such as reviewing app permissions, updating operating systems, checking privacy settings, deleting suspicious messages, logging out from unused devices, and monitoring account alerts. These habits reduce the chance of fraud as well as the impact of any attempted attack.

Awareness plus reporting creates accountability. If users remain silent, fraudsters continue targeting others. If incidents are documented and reported quickly, recovery chances improve and authorities receive stronger evidence.

Cyber safety is therefore a combination of caution before an incident and responsible action after an incident.

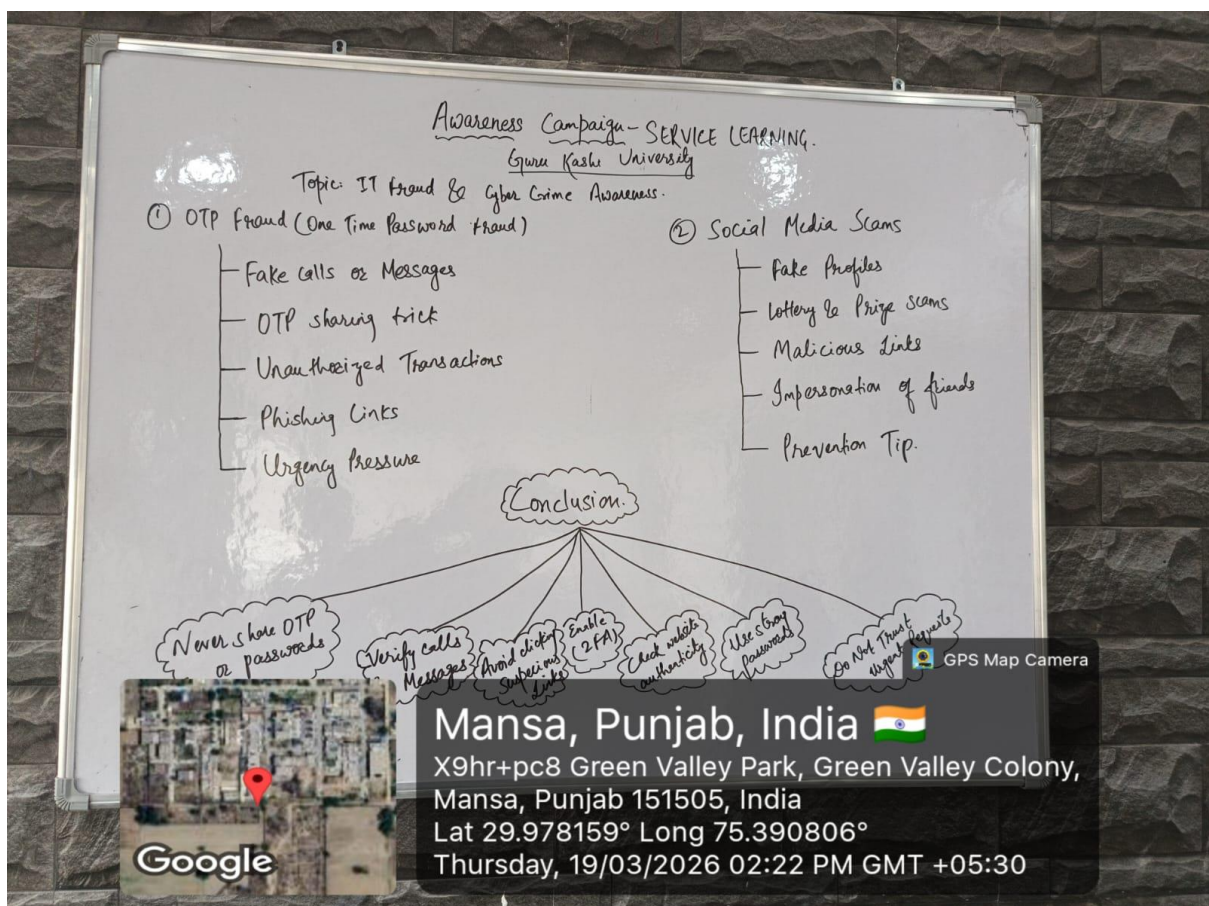
37. ATTENDANCE SHEET

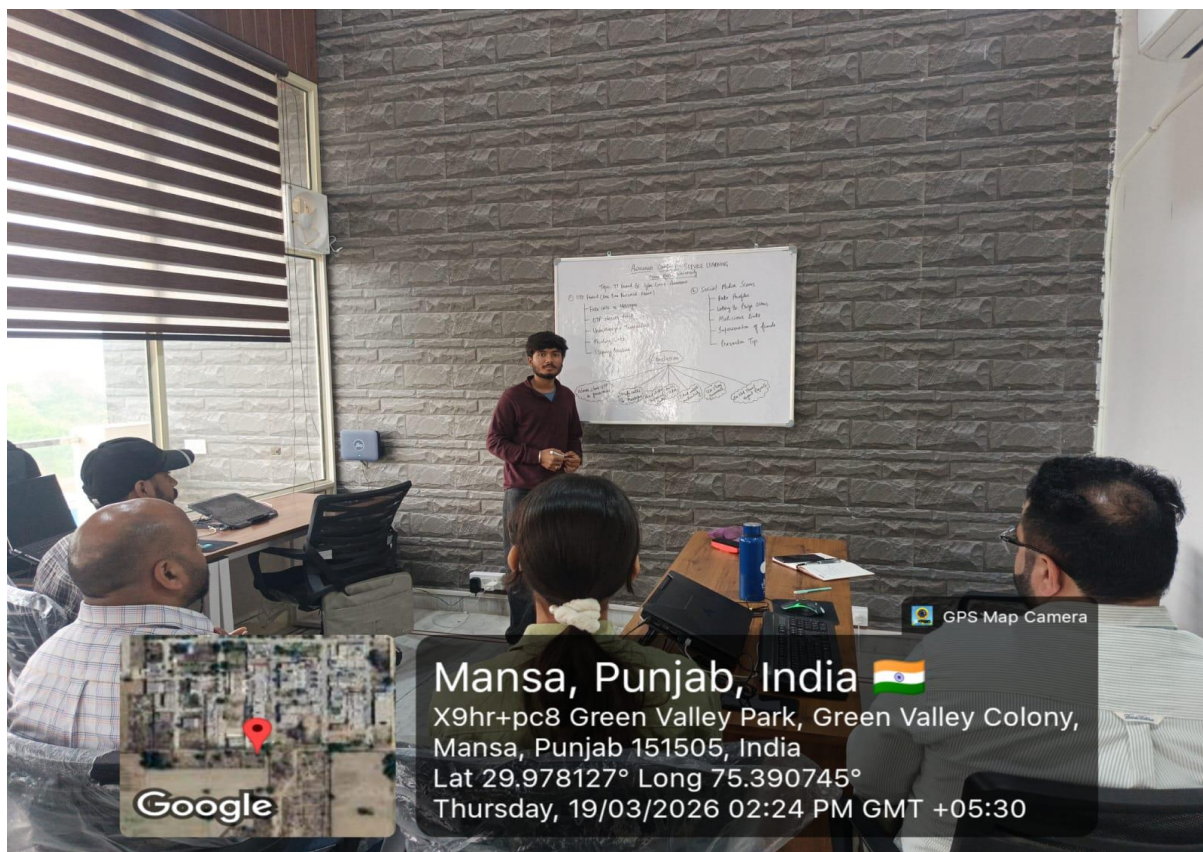
S. No.	Name	Contact No.
1	Manjeet Singh	9780009074
2	Anmol Goyal	7009524322
3	Sneha Jha	6201920599
4	Aakash Tiwari	6287268376
5	Anu	9478110467

The attendance sheet records the participants who took part in the awareness interaction during the service-learning activity.

38. PHOTOGRAPHS AND AWARENESS ACTIVITY

NOTES





GPS Map Camera

Mansa, Punjab, India 🇮🇳
X9hr+pc8 Green Valley Park, Green Valley Colony,
Mansa, Punjab 151505, India
Lat 29.978127° Long 75.390745°
Thursday, 19/03/2026 02:24 PM GMT +05:30



GPS Map Camera

Mansa, Punjab, India 🇮🇳
X9hr+pc8 Green Valley Park, Green Valley Colony,
Mansa, Punjab 151505, India
Lat 29.978128° Long 75.390746°
Thursday, 19/03/2026 02:24 PM GMT +05:30



Mansa, Punjab, India 🇮🇳

X9hr+pc8 Green Valley Park, Green Valley Colony,
Mansa, Punjab 151505, India

Lat 29.978134° Long 75.390747°

Thursday, 19/03/2026 02:24 PM GMT +05:30

39. CONCLUSION

In today's rapidly evolving digital world, cyber crimes are increasing because online communication, social networking, and digital payments have become deeply connected with everyday life. The risk is no longer limited to technical users; it affects ordinary people across all age groups and professions.

This project began with a focus on OTP fraud and social media scams and has now been expanded to include phishing, online banking fraud, identity theft, and cyberbullying. Together, these topics show that cyber threats can target money, privacy, identity, mental well-being, and public trust.

A major lesson from the report is that awareness remains the strongest practical defense. Fraudsters may change their stories, but they repeatedly rely on the same human reactions: panic, trust, curiosity, urgency, and lack of verification. People who stay calm, verify independently, protect their data, and report quickly are far less likely to become victims.

Therefore, cyber safety should be treated as a daily responsibility. A small step of awareness today can prevent a major financial or emotional loss tomorrow. An informed community creates a safer digital environment for everyone.